

SHUJA ALI

SENIOR FULL STACK ENGINEER · AI / LLM APPLICATIONS

Islamabad, Pakistan | shujaali1234@gmail.com | +92 302 513 3646 | linkedin.com/in/shujaali7 | github.com/shuja990 | shujaali.netlify.app

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior full-stack engineer with 5+ years building production-grade web applications across fintech, SaaS, and AI domains. Deep hands-on experience architecting MERN and Next.js systems from schema design through AWS deployment, with a specialty in LLM integrations - RAG pipelines, vector databases, and cost-aware OpenAI/Anthropic API usage. Currently the senior-most technical contributor across multiple product teams, owning system design, third-party integrations, and the hardest feature work personally.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

AI & Automation: OpenAI API, Anthropic (Claude) API, Gemini API, LangChain, RAG Pipelines, Vector Databases (FAISS, Pinecone), Prompt Caching, Playwright, Puppeteer

Frontend: React.js, Next.js (App Router, SSR/SSG/ISR), TypeScript, JavaScript (ES6+), Redux Toolkit, React Query, TailwindCSS, Shadcn/ui, Mantine UI

Backend: Node.js, Express.js, NestJS, GraphQL (Apollo), WebSockets (Socket.io), RESTful API Design, Background Jobs & Queues

Databases & Caching: MongoDB, PostgreSQL, Redis, Mongoose, Aggregation Pipelines

Payments: Stripe (Subscriptions, Webhooks, Connect), PayPal

Cloud & DevOps: AWS (EC2, S3, RDS), Docker, GitHub Actions, PM2, CI/CD Pipelines

Testing & Tooling: Jest, Playwright, Postman, Swagger/OpenAPI, Git, GitHub Copilot, Cursor, Claude Code

Working Knowledge: Python, FastAPI, AWS Lambda, CloudWatch, React Native, Sentry, GCP/Azure

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Technical Lead - Ropstam Solutions, Islamabad Nov 2024 - Present

- **Own architecture across multiple concurrent projects:** data models, API contracts, and service boundaries spanning MERN, Next.js, and mobile stacks.
- Build critical features personally - Stripe payment flows, OpenAI/LLM integrations, and complex multi-step workflows.
- Introduced Redis caching on high-read endpoints, reducing average response times on read-heavy features.
- Handle production incidents end-to-end: root-cause analysis, fix deployment, and follow-up safeguards to prevent recurrence.
- Mentor engineers through code reviews and pair programming; authored internal standards for API design, Git workflows, and security practices.

Team Lead - MERN Stack - Ropstam Solutions, Islamabad Jul 2023 - Nov 2024

- **Built RAG pipelines with LangChain and FAISS/Pinecone** for document Q&A; introduced prompt-level caching that cut OpenAI API costs.
- Implemented Socket.io real-time features - chat, notifications, collaborative editing - with Redis pub/sub for multi-instance deployments.
- Provisioned AWS infrastructure (EC2, S3, RDS) with load balancing and auto-scaling; migrated projects off shared hosting, improving uptime stability.
- Migrated JavaScript codebases to TypeScript, enforcing strict types across API boundaries.
- **Led a MERN development team while staying majority hands-on**, alongside sprint planning, PR reviews, and BitBucket CI/CD pipelines for automated staging/production deploys.

MERN Stack Developer - Ropstam Solutions, Islamabad Jul 2022 - Jun 2023

- Built production applications end-to-end: Express.js API design, MongoDB schema design, and React frontend architecture.
- **Substantially reduced reporting query times** by restructuring MongoDB aggregation pipelines and adding compound indexes on high-traffic endpoints.
- Integrated Stripe and PayPal with webhook handling for subscription lifecycle events and idempotency-key enforcement.
- Implemented JWT authentication with refresh-token rotation and OAuth2; structured token invalidation to reduce session-hijacking exposure.
- Diagnosed and resolved Node.js memory leaks in production services using heap snapshots and load profiling.

Freelance Full Stack Developer - Fiverr / Upwork (Remote) Apr 2020 - Present

- Delivered ~50 client projects across fintech, SaaS, and e-commerce, with repeat clients and end-to-end ownership from requirements to deployment.
- Built AI-powered tools including document editors with inline GPT suggestions and real-time collaboration over WebSockets.
- Managed full deployment lifecycle independently on AWS and DigitalOcean.

NOTABLE PROJECTS

LVL Parking Platform (app.lvlparking.com) - *React, Node.js, MongoDB, Stripe, Socket.io, AWS*

Parking management SaaS with real-time bay availability, Stripe subscription billing, and an operator admin dashboard. Designed a WebSocket-based availability system that updates clients on spot-status changes without polling; Stripe webhooks handle subscription state transitions with idempotent event processing.

Podcast AI (podcast-ai.devmatations.com) - *Next.js, OpenAI API, AWS S3, PostgreSQL*

Text-to-audio generator converting written content into podcast-style audio via OpenAI TTS. Implemented streaming audio delivery to avoid large-file buffering; generated files stored on S3 with signed-URL access, plus a content management layer for editing and regenerating episodes.

FinanceFlow (securebank.devmatations.com) - *Next.js, TypeScript, PostgreSQL*

Multi-account personal finance platform with bank-account linking and fund transfers. Structured PostgreSQL schema for multi-account transaction history with optimized lookups; OAuth-based auth flow with encrypted token storage.

Backdrop AI (backdrop-ai.devmatations.com) - *React, Node.js, Cloudinary API, MongoDB*

Image-editing tool with AI-powered background removal and generative fill via Cloudinary. Handled large image uploads with client-side compression to reduce processing time and storage costs.

SmartFormBot - *Node.js, Playwright, Puppeteer*

Browser-automation tool for structured form data extraction with conditional form logic and dynamic field detection, built on Playwright browser-context management. Configurable via JSON schema so non-engineers can define new form targets without code changes.

EDUCATION

B.Sc. Software Engineering - COMSATS University Islamabad 2018 - 2022

CERTIFICATIONS

- Python for Data Engineering - Coursera
- Python for Applied Data Science - Coursera
- Complete Web Developer Bootcamp - Udemy